multicultural India's society and the tragic consequences of partition's conflicts with neighboring Pakistan.

Fifty years later, in May 1998, India and Pakistan each successfully exploded five underground atomic bombs, joining the world's nuclear club. With their capitals and major cities less than ten ballistic missile–minutes from each other, the two countries have become the world's most dangerous match for the potential ignition of a nuclear war that could decimate South Asia and poison every region on earth. So unthinkable a global tragedy almost occurred in the summer of 1999 in Kargil and, once again, along the Kashmir Line of Control in 2002.

For over forty years I have been passionately concerned about the Indo-Pakistani conflict over Kashmir and the dreadful damage it has done to that beautiful state and its people. Since these two nations acquired nuclear arms, the dangers of their continued conflict have escalated disastrously. It is more urgent now than ever to resolve that dispute. Yet the possibility of nuclear war in South Asia has only increased in the past seven years, as Pakistan's polity lurched from unpopular martial rule under President General Musharraf to unstable civil rule under President Asif Ali Zardari. Pakistan's army is currently engaged in civil war with Taliban terrorists allied to Al-Qaeda (The Base) in Waziristan's North-West Frontier Province. Should even one of Pakistan's nuclear warheads fall into Taliban hands, it could be used by their suicide bombers to wreak havoc in India's largest city, as did the ten Pakistani terrorists who sailed from Karachi to Mumbai on November 26, 2008, launching three days and nights of atrocities there, killing 163 innocent people, setting fire to the Taj Mahal and Oberoi hotels, and desecrating the Chhatrapati Shivaji central railway terminus, Nariman House's Chabad Jewish Center, and the Cama Hospital. Trained and guided by Pakistan's Lashkar-e-Tayiba (Army of Allah), these terrorists were armed only with Kalashnikov rifles, hand grenades, and ordinary bombs, but the horror of that attack would have been magnified incalculably by a nuclear weapon. In July 2006, Lashkar trainers had launched suicide bombers against crowded commuter trains in Mumbai, killing 160 Indians during the morning rush hour.

Those tragic Mumbai attacks underscore the threat of the close proximity of two nuclear arsenals and the urgency to India and Pakistan of cooperating in their resolve to crush terrorism, whatever its national origins or religious beliefs. The two nations should quickly agree upon the creation of an efficient Indo-Pakistani anti-terror commission to